



Sentence & Parts of Speech

E-Book

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Sentence & Parts of Speech

Introduction:

To be able to speak and write effectively, it is essential to be aware of the structure of words and how words come together to form meaningful sentences which makes effective communication possible. Grammar includes the rules and principles which determine the structure & usages of sentences.

Generally questions are based on either Fundamentals of Grammar or Application of Grammar.

In this eBook, we shall be covering fundamentals & topics are:

1. Components of a sentence
2. Parts of speech – an overview

Relevance in entrance tests

In the verbal ability section of various tests, questions on grammar fundamentals are frequently asked. The questions are generally based on identifying the components of a sentence, identifying parts of speech of a word in a sentence, & fill in the blanks based on tenses, modals, prepositions & articles. The number of questions could vary from 3-6 questions depending on the type of test you are taking.

These questions are less time consuming to solve. Hence, with some basic concepts on grammar you can score in this section.

Skills required

- Your ability to understand the usage of correct English language



- Being familiar with basic grammar.
- Time and speed to solve these questions

Format of questions asked

Grammar questions can be asked in many formats & these are as follow:

I. Identify the parts of speech or components in a sentence

II. Fill in the blanks:

Single blank or cloze test based on - Prepositions, Tenses, Articles, Determiners, Phrasal verbs & Modals

I. Identify the parts of speech or components in a sentence:-

In this type, knowledge of grammar fundamentals is required as you will be asked to identify the nature of the underlined word in a sentence or sometimes match the word with exact type in terms of its role in a sentence.

For examples:

1. Choose the suitable part of speech for the underlined word in the given sentence:

He knows me **better** than you.

- | | |
|--------------|----------------|
| A) Adjective | B) Preposition |
| C) Adverb | D) Conjunction |

Ans. (C) Adverb is the correct answer as it is modifying verb 'knows'.



2. Match the sentences given in List - I with the kinds of adverbs used in List - II

List - I (Sentences)		List - II (Kinds of adverbs)	
a.	They often make mistakes	i.	Adverb of manner
b.	She looked up	ii.	Adverb of time
c.	They sang delightfully	iii.	Adverb of frequency
d.	I have read this before	iv.	Adverb of place

Choose the correct answer from the options given below:

- A) a-iii, b-iv, c-i, d-ii B) a-ii, b-i, c-iii, d-iv
C) a-iv, b-iii, c-ii, d-i D) a-ii, b-iii, c-iv, d-i

Ans. (A) Often is frequency, Up is place,
Delightfully is manner, Before is time.

3. Fill in the blank with the most appropriate adverb from the given options:

He _____ talks ill of his friends.

- A) where B) immediately
C) never D) slowly

Ans. (C) Never fits best as context is of showing frequency of event.

4. Choose the correct option to fill in the blank with the correct adverb.

He usually cuts my hair ____.

- A) quick B) Quickly
C) more quickly D) Quicker

Ans. (B) The blank will be filled by an adverb. More quickly can't come here since there is no comparison.



5. Complete the sentence with Adverb of Manner

Heena delivered the speech _____

- A) yesterday B) fluently
C) where D) probably

Ans. (B) The adverb of manner in the given options is 'fluently' as it answers 'how the action happened'

II. Fill in the blanks

Here questions are based on usages of prepositions, tenses, articles, determiners, phrasal verbs & modals.

DIRECTIONS: Fill in the following blanks with appropriate prepositions.

1. Come what may I shall adhere _____ my principles.

- A) with B) to C) on D) upon

Ans. (B) With 'adhere' the standard preposition is 'to'.

2. When did you last see your parents? _____ days ago.

- A) A little B) A few
C) Little D) Much

Ans. (B) "few" is used for things that are countable, "a few" means less in number.

3. I _____ to Paris last year

- A) did not go B) did not went
C) never went go D) never

Ans. (A) The sentence shows a past action of the last year so 'never' can't be used. Option (A) is the correct option as it is grammatically correct.



4. Shyam's hostel mate has become _____ IAS officer.
A) a B) the
C) an D) zero article

Ans. (C) 'An' as word after it us starting with vowel

5. My car _____ again yesterday, I should buy a new one.
A) break into B) breaks down
C) break up D) broke down

Ans. (D) As past tense is being talked about, second form of the verb will be used.

Cloze Test Format

In this type a paragraph containing multiple blanks is given and one has to find the correct words from the given options. Again, the concepts & tricks will remain the same as used to solve sentence completion questions in general. The tricks required to solve sentence completion questions based on vocabulary are given in sentence completion chapter.

Let us look at one example to understand the format:

DIRECTIONS: Fill in the blanks of the paragraph with appropriate prepositions.

The wings of some birds are so small that they are (6) for flying. Earlier such birds (7) fly. But after living for thousands of (8) in places where they had no (9) there was no need for them to fly, and they (10) on the ground. After a while their (11) ones could no longer rise into the air. The ostrich, rhea, emu and cassowary (12) fly, but they can run fast on their long, strong legs. Ostriches (13) in Africa and are found on the grassy places (14)



they live along with big groups of zebras. The rhea looks like the ostrich, **(15)** it is smaller and has three toes on each feet, while the ostrich has only two.

- | | | |
|-----|----------------|-----------------|
| 6. | A) useless | B) useful |
| | C) beneficial | D) suited |
| 7. | A) should | B) might |
| | C) could | D) can |
| 8. | A) weeks | B) years |
| | C) months | D) ages |
| 9. | A) wind | B) sky |
| | C) friends | D) enemies |
| 10. | A) stepped | B) stayed |
| | C) crept | D) crawled |
| 11. | A) trained | B) old |
| | C) young | D) pregnant |
| 12. | A) cannot | B) could |
| | C) would | D) should |
| 13. | A) lived | B) Live |
| | C) had lived | D) used to live |
| 14. | A) when | B) where |
| | C) so that | D) because |
| 15. | A) even though | B) But |
| | C) and | (D) in spite of |

Solutions

Q.	Key	Explanation
6.	A	So small....indicates they are useless...as all other choices indicate otherwise.
7.	C	Could (past)indicates possibility of flying
8.	A	Years (long time is indicated).
9.	D	There was no need for the birds to fly as they had no enemies....absence of no other factor proves this.
10.	B	Stayed on ground. (anything else is not indicative, hence general word....stayed).
11.	C	Young ones means new borns, offsprings.
12.	A	But they can run fast.....indicate....they cannot fly.
13.	B	Present tense will come....as hinted by (are flying).
14.	B	The sentence indicates...place...hence use of where.
15.	B	As comparison is taking place.... smaller..... use of but is necessary.

Fundamentals of Grammar

1. Sentence & its components

A sentence is the meaningful arrangement of the words to convey the context of a situation. It has components such as subject, verb, object in the simplest form. It has main clause & a subordinate clause.

Let us define a few basic terms:

- **Subject:** The subject is the person, place, thing or idea that is doing or being something in the sentence.



For example – *The cat sleeps on the mat.*

Here something has been said about the cat or cat is doing the action of 'sleeping' so 'cat' is the subject in this sentence.

- **Verb:** The verb expresses action or state of being.

In the above example, 'sleeps' is a verb.

- **Object:** An object receives the action of the verb in a sentence. It can be direct object or an indirect object.

For example – *She gave him a book.*

Here 'book' is the direct object and 'him' is an indirect object

- **Predicate:** The predicate is the part of the sentence that tells something about the subject. It usually contains the verb and can also include objects, complements, and adverbial modifiers.

In "The cat sleeps on the mat," "sleeps on the mat" is the predicate

How to identify the subject in a sentence:

To climb the mountain is difficult.

Let's apply the short cut.

What is difficult?

Ans. To climb the mountain

That's why '*to climb the mountain*' is the subject of this statement.



2. Parts of Speech

Here, we will acquaint you with basic terms of Grammar. This topic is important as most of the questions that appear in the tests are based on basic concepts.

After going through the terms, solve the exercise given in the topic.

In grammar, a part of speech (also called lexical categories, grammatical categories or word classes) is a linguistic category of words. In English there are eight parts of speech.

- (a) **Noun:** A noun is a word used to refer to people, animals, objects, substances, states, events, ideas and feelings. A noun functions as a subject or object of a verb and can be modified by an adjective.

Examples:

(1) Rohan is my best friend.

(2) John, lion, table, freedom, love.

- (b) **Adjective:** Adjectives are used to describe or specify a noun or pronoun.

Examples:

(1) Megha is a beautiful girl.

(2) gentle, good, ugly, nice.

- (c) **Pronoun:** A pronoun is used in the place of a noun or phrase (known as the antecedent).



Examples:

(1) The pronoun is a lonely word; it must always be paired with an antecedent.

(2) I, you, he, she, it.

- (d) **Verb:** A verb is used to show an action or a state of being.

Examples:

(1) He is writing an essay.

(2) go, think, walk, dance, assume.

- (e) **Adverb:** An adverb is used to modify a verb, adjective and other adverbs.

Examples:

(1) He sat quietly under the tree.

(2) completely, politely, never, there.

- (f) **Preposition:** Prepositions are used before nouns to form a phrase that shows where, when, how and why.

Examples:

(1) He sat under the tree.

(2) in, above, to, for, at.

- (g) **Conjunction:** Conjunctions join clauses or sentences or words.

Examples:

(1) Either Varun or Arjun will win the race.

(2) and, but, however, so, although



- (h) **Interjection:** Interjections are used to show surprise or emotion.

Examples:

- (1) Oh! Good Lord.
(2) bravo, hurrah, alas.

A. Nouns

What is a Noun?

A noun is a word that represents a person, place, or thing. Everything we can see or talk about is represented by a word. That word is called a "noun." You might find it useful to think of a noun as a "naming word." Often a noun is the name for something we can touch (e.g., "lion," "cake," "computer"), but sometimes a noun names something we cannot touch (e.g., "bravery", "smile", "joy").

Types of nouns:-

- i. **Common Nouns:** These are general names for a person, place, or thing. They are not capitalized unless they start a sentence.
Examples: dog, city, book.
- ii. **Proper Nouns:** These refer to specific names of people, places, or organizations and are always capitalized.
Examples: Michael, Paris, Microsoft.
- iii. **Concrete Nouns:** These are nouns that you can perceive through your five senses.



Examples: apple (you can see and taste), music (you can hear).

- iv. **Abstract Nouns:** These are nouns that represent ideas, qualities, or states that cannot be seen or touched.

Examples: love, freedom, intelligence.

- v. **Countable Nouns:** These nouns can be counted as they refer to individual items or units.

Examples: car (three cars), idea (many ideas).

- vi. **Uncountable Nouns (or Mass Nouns):** These refer to things that cannot be counted because they are seen as wholes or masses.

Examples: water, sand, air.

- vii. **Collective Nouns:** These nouns refer to groups of people, animals, or things.

Examples: team (referring to players), flock (referring to birds).

- viii. **Compound Nouns:** These are nouns made up of two or more words which can be written as one-word, separate words, or hyphenated.

Examples: toothpaste, mother-in-law, school bus.

Examples:

- *Person:* soldier, Alan, cousin, lawyer
- *Place:* house, London, factory, shelter
- *Objects:* table, London Bridge, chisel, nitrogen, month, inch



- *Activity:* cooking, swimming
- *Animals:* aardvark, rat, shark, Mickey
- *Ideas:* confusion, kindness, faith, Theory of Relativity, joy

B. Pronouns

What is a Pronoun?

A pronoun is a word used instead of a Noun. It helps us avoid repetition of the noun every time we make a reference to the same noun.

Here are the main types of pronouns:

- Personal Pronouns:** These pronouns represent specific people or things. They are categorized based on person (first, second, or third), number (singular or plural), and gender (masculine, feminine, neuter).

Examples: "I," "you," "he," "she," "it," "we," and "they."

Examples:

<u>I</u> am tired.	<u>We</u> are tired.
<u>You</u> are tired.	<u>You</u> are tired.
<u>He (she, it)</u> is tired.	<u>They</u> are tired.

All the underlined words are called *Personal Pronouns*.

Personal Pronouns have three forms:

- Subject Form** - Ask the question 'Who' before the verb.
I (you, we, he, they) ate the mango.



2. **Possessive Form** - Ask the question 'whose' before the verb.

The Mango is mine (*yours, ours, his, theirs*).

3. **Object Form** - Ask the question 'whom/to whom' after the verb.

The student hates me (*you, us, him, them*).

The mango belongs to me (*you, us, him, them*).

- ii. **Possessive Pronouns:** These indicate ownership or possession.

Examples: "mine," "yours," "his," "hers," "its," "ours," and "theirs."

- iii. **Reflexive Pronouns:** Used when the subject and the object of the sentence are the same, these pronouns end in "-self" or "-selves."

Examples: "myself," "yourself," "himself," "herself," "itself," "ourselves," "yourselves," and "themselves."

- iv. **Demonstrative Pronouns:** These are used to point to specific things.

Examples: "this," "that," "these," and "those."

- v. **Interrogative Pronouns:** Used to ask questions.

Examples: "who," "whom," "whose," "which," and "what."

- vi. **Relative Pronouns:** These are used to connect a clause or phrase to a noun or pronoun.

Examples: "who," "whom," "whose," "which," and "that."



vii. Indefinite Pronouns: These refer to nonspecific things or people.

Examples: "anyone," "anything," "each," "few," "many," "nobody," "none," "several," and "some."

viii. Reciprocal Pronouns: These express a mutual action or relationship.

There are only two in English: "each other" and "one another."

ix. Intensive/Emphatic Pronouns: Similar to reflexive pronouns but used for emphasis. They also end in "-self" or "-selves" and are used to intensify the emphasis on the subject.

Examples: "myself," "yourself," "himself," "herself," "itself," "ourselves," "yourselves," and "themselves."

Examples:

(1) The pronoun is a lonely word; it must always be paired with an antecedent.

(2) I, you, he, she, it.

C. Adjectives

What is an Adjective?

An Adjective is a word, which describes or modifies a noun & a pronoun. It tells us more about the noun and pronoun.

Examples:

- Arup is a **good** boy.
- This is a **small** house.
- They need a **wise** man to solve this issue.

Adjectives can be compared and there are three degrees of comparison.

Types of adjectives:

- i. **Descriptive Adjectives (Qualitative Adjectives):** These adjectives describe the qualities or states of beings of nouns. They can provide subjective opinions and are the most common type of adjectives.

Examples: happy, blue, small, noisy.

- ii. **Quantitative Adjectives:** These adjectives indicate the quantity of nouns or pronouns.

Examples: some, many, few, several.

- iii. **Demonstrative Adjectives:** These adjectives point to specific nouns.

Examples: this, that, these, those.

- iv. **Possessive Adjectives:** These adjectives indicate possession or ownership.

Examples: my, your, his, her, its, our, their.

- v. **Interrogative Adjectives:** These adjectives are used in questions. They modify nouns and are used with them to ask questions.

Examples: which, what, whose.

- vi. **Distributive Adjectives:** These adjectives refer to individual elements within a group.

Examples: each, every, either, neither.



- vii. **Articles:** In English grammar, articles are often considered a type of adjective as after them, generally nouns are used. There are definite (the) and indefinite (a, an) articles.

Examples: the (definite article), a (indefinite article), an (indefinite article).

- viii. **Proper Adjectives:** These adjectives are derived from proper nouns and usually denote origin, nationality, or religious affiliation. They are always capitalized.

Examples: American, Shakespearean, Christian.

- ix. **Comparative Adjectives:** These adjectives are used to compare two things. They often end in "-er" or are preceded by the word "more."

Examples: bigger, smarter, more interesting.

- x. **Superlative Adjectives:** These adjectives are used to compare three or more things and express the highest degree. They often end in "-est" or are preceded by the word "most."

Examples: happiest, smallest, most beautiful.

D. Verbs

What are Verbs?

Verbs are "doing" words. Verbs can express:

- A physical action (e.g., "to swim," "to write," "to climb").
- A mental action (e.g., "to think," "to guess," "to consider").
- A state of being (e.g., "to be," "to exist," "to appear").



Examples:

- The dog is jumping with joy.
- I think I can solve this mystery.
- That matter is consuming a lot of time.
- Rebha has to appear as a witness for the case.

The principal (chief) parts of a Verb, from which all other forms can be obtained, are:

Here are the main types of verbs:

- i. **Action Verbs:** These verbs express physical or mental actions.

For example: "run," "think," "play," and "create."

- ii. **Linking Verbs:** Linking verbs connect the subject of a sentence to a subject complement. They typically relate to states of being.

For example: "be," "seem," "become," and "appear."

- iii. **Auxiliary (Helping) Verbs:** These verbs are used with a main verb to form a verb phrase, indicating tense, mood, or voice.

Examples: "have," "do," "will," "can," and "must."

- iv. **Modal Verbs:** A subtype of auxiliary verbs, modals express necessity, possibility, permission, or ability.

Examples: "can," "may," "must," "should," and "might."



- v. **Transitive Verbs:** These verbs require a direct object to complete their meaning.

For example: "She reads a book," "reads" is a transitive verb and "a book" is its direct object.

- vi. **Intransitive Verbs:** In contrast to transitive verbs, intransitive verbs do not need a direct object.

Example: "He sleeps."

- vii. **Phrasal Verbs:** These are combinations of a verb and a preposition or an adverb, forming a new unit with a distinct meaning.

For instance, "give up" or "break down."

- viii. **Irregular Verbs:** Verbs that do not follow the regular pattern of adding "-ed" for past tense and past participle forms.

For example: "go" (went, gone), "buy" (bought, bought), and "eat" (ate, eaten).

- ix. **Regular Verbs:** Verbs that follow a consistent pattern in the past tense and past participle, typically by adding "-ed" to the base form.

For example: "walk" becomes "walked," and "call" becomes "called."

- x. **Stative Verbs:** These verbs describe a state or condition rather than an action. They often relate to thoughts, emotions, relationships, senses, states of being, and measurements.

For example: "believe," "love," "own," and "seem."

E. Adverbs

What is an adverb?

An adverb is a word that can modify a verb, an adjective, or another adverb. Lots of adverbs end in "-ly."

Examples:

- She swims **quickly**.
(Here, the adverb "quickly" modifies the verb "swims.")
- She is an **extremely** quick swimmer.
(The adverb "extremely" modifies the adjective "quick.")
- She swims **extremely quickly**.
(The adverb "extremely" modifies the adverb "quickly.")

Here are the main types of adverbs:

- i. **Adverbs of Manner:** Describe how something is done or how something happens.

They often end in "-ly" and answer the question "how?".

Examples: quickly, slowly, carefully, badly.

Let us understand them by a few examples:

- a. She sang beautifully."

Adverb of Manner: Beautifully

The adverb 'beautifully' describes how she sang. It provides information on the quality of her singing, suggesting that it was done in a beautiful way.



- b. The cat slept soundly on the couch.

Adverb of Manner: Soundly

Here, 'soundly' is the adverb describing the verb 'slept.' It tells us that the cat was sleeping in a deep, undisturbed manner, emphasizing the quality and depth of its sleep.

- c. He quickly finished his homework.

Adverb of Manner: Quickly

'Quickly' is the adverb modifying the verb 'finished.' This sentence tells us that the action of finishing his homework was done at a fast pace. The adverb 'quickly' focuses on the speed of the action.

- ii. **Adverbs of Place:** Indicate where the action is taking place. They answer the question "where?".

Examples: here, there, everywhere, nowhere.

Let us look at a few examples to understand this type:

- a. The dog is sleeping underneath the table.

In this sentence, "underneath" is the adverb of place, indicating where the dog is sleeping.

- b. Please, come inside; it's cold out there.

Here, "inside" is the adverb of place, used to suggest moving to a location inside from outside.

- c. They searched everywhere for the lost keys.



"Everywhere" is the adverb of place in this sentence, indicating that the search was conducted in all possible locations.

- iii. **Adverbs of Time:** Tell us when an action happened, but also for how long, and how often. They answer the question "when?".

Examples: now, then, later, yesterday, soon, always, often, never.

Let us look at a few examples to understand this type:

- a. She always does her homework before dinner.

In this sentence, "always" is the adverb of time, indicating the frequency with which she does her homework.

- b. The train will depart shortly.

Here, "shortly" is the adverb of time, suggesting that the train's departure will happen soon.

- c. He occasionally visits the museum to find inspiration.

"Occasionally" is the adverb of time in this sentence, indicating that his visits to the museum happen from time to time, but not regularly.

- iv. **Adverbs of Frequency:** Indicate how often something happens. They answer the question "how often?".

Examples: always, frequently, rarely, seldom, usually.



Let us look at a few examples to understand this type:

- a. He often goes for a run in the morning.

In this sentence, "often" is the adverb of frequency, indicating that he goes for a run regularly, but not necessarily every day.

- b. They rarely eat out at restaurants.

Here, "rarely" is the adverb of frequency, suggesting that eating out is an infrequent occurrence for them.

- c. She never forgets to call her grandmother on Sundays."

"Never" is the adverb of frequency in this sentence, indicating that she consistently remembers to call her grandmother every Sunday without fail.

- v. **Adverbs of Degree:** Describe the intensity, degree, or extent of the verb, adjective, or another adverb it's modifying. They answer the question "how much?" or "to what degree?".

Examples: very, quite, almost, too, enough.

Let us look at a few examples to understand this type:

- a. The soup is extremely hot, so be careful.

In this sentence, "extremely" is the adverb of degree, emphasizing the high temperature of the soup.

- b. He was quite pleased with the results of the exam."

Here, "quite" is the adverb of degree, indicating a moderate level of pleasure.



- c. She barely passed the driving test."

"Barely" is the adverb of degree in this sentence, suggesting that she passed the test by a very small margin.

- vi. Adverbs of Probability:** Express the likelihood of something happening.

Examples: probably, possibly, surely, definitely.

Let us look at a few examples to understand this type:

- a. She will probably arrive by 3 PM."

In this sentence, "probably" is the adverb of probability, indicating that there is a high likelihood of her arriving by 3 PM.

- b. He might join us for dinner."

Here, "might" is the adverb of probability, suggesting there is a possibility of him joining for dinner, but it's not certain.

- c. They will definitely be at the concert tonight."

Definitely" is the adverb of probability in this sentence, conveying a strong certainty that they will be at the concert.

- vii. Interrogative Adverbs:** Used to ask questions.

They include: where, when, why, how.



Let us look at a few examples to understand this type:

- a. How did you learn to speak French so fluently?

In this sentence, "how" is the interrogative adverb asking about the manner in which something was done.

- b. Where is the nearest post office?

Here, "where" is used to inquire about the location of something.

- c. Why do birds migrate in the winter?

In this example, "why" is the interrogative adverb asking for the reason or cause of an action.

- viii. **Relative Adverbs:** Introduce relative clauses and are related to the question words. Relative adverbs are used to link clauses or phrases in a sentence, and they refer to time, reason, or place.

They include: where, when, why.

Let us look at a few examples to understand this type:

- a. When you called, I was just leaving the house.

In this sentence, "when" is a relative adverb that introduces a time-related clause, explaining the timing of two events.

- b. Where the river meets the sea, there is a beautiful delta.

Here, "where" is the relative adverb that introduces a clause describing the location or place of the delta.

- c. Why the machine stopped working is still a mystery.



In this example, "why" is a relative adverb introducing a clause that gives the reason or cause of the machine's failure.

- ix. Conjunctive Adverbs:** Used to connect clauses or sentences, indicating a relationship between them. Conjunctive adverbs are used to connect two independent clauses or sentences, indicating a relationship like contrast, cause, or effect.

Examples: however, therefore, moreover, consequently

Let us look at a few examples to understand this type:

- a. However, she still believes that the project can be completed on time.

In this sentence, "however" is a conjunctive adverb that introduces a contrast or contradiction to the previous statement.

- b. The team worked hard; therefore, they completed the project ahead of schedule.

Here, "therefore" is used as a conjunctive adverb to indicate a cause-and-effect relationship between the two clauses.

- c. She was feeling unwell; nevertheless, she decided to attend the meeting.

In this example, "nevertheless" is a conjunctive adverb that introduces a statement that contradicts or defies the expectation set by the first clause.

F. Conjunctions

What are conjunctions?

Conjunctions are joining words. They may join words, phrases or sentences.

Examples: And, But, Although, While, However, If, Yet, Lest, etc.

Relative pronouns such as: *that, which, who, whom, and whose* are also used as conjunctions.

There are 3 types of Conjunctions: -

Coordinating conjunctions (FANBOYS METHOD)	Subordinating conjunctions	Correlative Conjunctions
For(F)	after	either/or
And(A)	although	neither/nor
Nor(N)	as soon as	not only/but also
But(B)	because	as/as
Or(O)	before	both/and
Yet(Y)	by the time	whether/or
So(S)	in case	
	now that	
	since	
	unless	
	when	
	whether or not	
	while	



G. Prepositions

What is a Preposition?

A preposition is a word (usually a short word) that sits before a noun to show the noun's relationship with a nearby word.

Examples:

- A girl **from** our village

(Here, the preposition "from" sits before the noun "our village" to show the relationship between "our village" and "a girl.")

- A fish **for** the cat

(In this example, the preposition "for" sits before the noun "the cat" to show the relationship between "the cat" and "a fish.")

Types of Prepositions

A. Prepositions of Time

<i>For example:</i>		
On:	It is used for the exact time.	On Monday; on 17 th of September.
In:	It is used for seasons, months, years and some parts of the day. (except noon and midnight)	I will come home in June.
By:	It implies upto.	"He will finish this work by evening."



		(upto evening)
For:	It is used for the duration of action; it is generally used with perfect continuous tense.	"She has been working for five years."
Since:	It is used for point of time.	"She has been visiting this place since Friday."
From:	It is used for the starting point of an action.	"Today he worked from 11 a.m. to 5 p.m."

B. Prepositions of Position

<i>For example:</i>		
At:	As a preposition of position, it is used for small towns and villages.	"She was born at Baruipur village."
In:	It is used when refer to big cities and countries.	"Sona was born in India."
Between:	It is used when we refer to two persons or things	"What happened between these two I do not know."
Among:	It is used when we refer to more than two	"Among all the six brothers he is the best."
Above:	It means 'higher than'.	The roof is above us.



Over:	It means vertically above.	This fan is over the dinner table.
Below:	It means "lower than".	First floor is below second floor.
Under:	It means "vertically below."	Raja is sitting in the shade of the tree. There can be nothing vertically below the shade of the tree. But we can say "Raja is sitting under the tree."
Beneath:	It means lower position; it is used figuratively generally.	"It is beneath my dignity to request you."

C. Prepositions of Direction

<i>For example:</i>		
To:	It is used for exact destination	"I am going to my school."
Towards:	It is used when we refer to direction	"I am going towards the bus stop." It means "in the direction of"
Into:	It refers to the movement towards the interior	"He jumped into the river." (not in the river)
At:	It is used when we want to say 'face to	She was sitting at the table. (not on the table)



	face with'	Her servant stood at the ticket window. (not on the ticket window) Sheetal was looking at his photograph. (not on his photograph)
For:	Sometimes, for also denotes directions,	'Sahil is leaving for Pune today.'
Against:	It means 'pressing against'	'Harini was standing against the wall when I saw her.'
Off:	It is used when two things are separated	"The airplane took off at 9 p.m."
From:	It is used for the point of departure	"They have come from the college."



Practice Exercise

DIRECTIONS for questions 1 to 3: *Identify the subject in the given sentences.*

1. Underneath the ancient oak tree, many colorful flowers bloom tirelessly,
A) ancient oak tree B) myriad
C) flowers D) underneath
2. Throughout the city, numerous skyscrapers, towering above the horizon, create a stunning skyline.
A) city B) horizon
C) skyscrapers D) skyline
3. Inside the old, abandoned mansion, whispers of the past seem to echo in every corner."
A) mansion B) whispers
C) past D) corner

DIRECTIONS for questions 4 to 5: *Identify the object in the given sentences.*

4. She gave her friend a beautiful gift.
A) She B) Gave
C) Friend D) Gift
5. The dog chased the cat around the yard.
A) Dog B) Chased
C) Cat D) Yard



DIRECTIONS for questions 6 to 10: *Identify the part of speech of the word highlighted in bold in each of the following sentences given below.*

6. The **swiftly** flowing river mesmerized us.
A) Adjective B) Adverb
C) Noun D) Preposition
7. The place **where** we met was unforgettable.
A) Adverb B) Conjunction
C) Pronoun D) Preposition
8. She **had** finished her work before sunset.
A) Verb B) Adverb
C) Noun D) Preposition
9. Despite the heavy rain, we **enjoyed** the concert.
A) Verb B) Adjective
C) Adverb D) Noun
10. The artist **whose** work we admire is coming to town.
A) Adjective B) Pronoun
C) Preposition D) Conjunction

Answer Key & Explanation

Q.	Key	Explanation
1.	C	In "Underneath the ancient oak tree many colorful flowers bloom tirelessly," the subject is 'flowers'. Despite the introductory phrase about the oak tree, it's the flowers that are performing the action (blooming).
2.	C	The subject of "Throughout the city, numerous skyscrapers, towering above the horizon, create a stunning skyline" is 'skyscrapers'. They are the noun performing the action of creating the skyline.
3.	B	In "Inside the old, abandoned mansion, whispers of the past seem to echo in every corner," the subject is 'whispers'. The sentence focuses on the whispers echoing, not the mansion itself.
4.	D	The object in the sentence is the noun that receives the action of the verb. In this sentence, "gift" is the object because it is what was given.
5.	C	The object is what the subject is acting upon. Here, "cat" is the object because it is what the dog chased.
6.	B	In "The swiftly flowing river mesmerized us," 'swiftly' is an adverb because it modifies the verb 'flowing', describing how the river flows.
7.	D	'Where' in "The place where we met was unforgettable" functions as a preposition introducing the prepositional phrase 'where we



		met'.
8.	A	' Had ' in "She had finished her work before sunset" is a verb, specifically an auxiliary verb used to form the past perfect tense.
9.	A	' Enjoyed ' in "Despite the heavy rain, we enjoyed the concert" is a verb, indicating the action performed by the subject 'we'.
10.	B	' Whose ' in "The artist whose work we admire is coming to town" is a pronoun, used to indicate possession ('whose work').